

SSA Application Assistance — Child Complete Worksheet

For parents and caregivers applying for SSI for a child under 18. Use it together with the Child step-by-step video in this package.

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The big picture: For a child, the benefit is SSI (Supplemental Security Income). Social Security looks at two things: (1) your child's medical condition and how it limits their everyday functioning, and (2) your household income and resources, because part of a parent's income counts toward the child (this is called "deeming"). A parent or caregiver applies — the child does not apply alone.

Part 1 — About Your Child and Family

Child's full name	
Child's date of birth	
Child's Social Security number	
Diagnoses / conditions	
Parent / caregiver applying	
Relationship to child	
Household income (monthly)	
Other benefits in the home	

Part 2 — Documents Checklist

- ☐ Child's birth certificate and Social Security card
- ☐ Proof of the child's citizenship or legal status
- ☐ Parent's photo ID
- ☐ Proof of household income — pay stubs, benefits letters (deeming information)
- ☐ Bank statements and resource information for the household
- ☐ Medical records — every doctor, hospital, clinic, and therapist, with dates
- ☐ Medication list — name, dose, who prescribed it, and why
- ☐ School records — IEPs, 504 plans, report cards, testing and evaluations
- ☐ Teacher statements about how your child functions at school
- ☐ Therapy records — OT, PT, speech, ABA, behavioral health
- ☐ Names and contact information for people who see your child's daily struggles

Part 3 — How to Apply, Step by Step

Step 1 — Protect your filing date. Start right away: begin online at ssa.gov (child disability report), or call 1-800-772-1213 (TTY 1-800-325-0778) to start the SSI claim and schedule the interview. Payments can only go back so far — starting early protects money your child may be owed.

Step 2 — Complete the Child Disability Report. List every condition, every provider, and every medicine. Do not leave anything out — combine all conditions, because Social Security must consider them together.

Step 3 — Do the SSI interview. Social Security will ask about household income, resources, and living arrangements. Answer honestly and completely, and ask what documents they still need.

Step 4 — Turn in records fast. Send school and medical records as soon as you can. Ask the school in writing for complete records, and keep a copy of everything you send.

Step 5 — The consultative exam (if scheduled). Social Security may send your child to an exam with their doctor. Go, be on time, and tell that doctor the same honest story you told Social Security.

Step 6 — The decision. If approved, payments begin and Medicaid usually follows in Texas. If denied, you generally have 60 days to appeal — reconsideration first, then a hearing. Many child cases are approved on appeal with complete school and medical evidence.

Part 4 — The Six Areas of Functioning (Your Evidence Worksheet)

For a child, Social Security measures functioning in six areas (“domains”). Your child generally must show marked limits in two areas, or an extreme limit in one. Under each area, write real examples from everyday life — what happens, how often, and what help your child needs compared with other children the same age.

1. Acquiring and Using Information — learning, reading, math, understanding and remembering schoolwork

2. Attending and Completing Tasks — focus, finishing homework and chores, rushing, giving up, needing reminders

3. Interacting and Relating With Others — speech and language, making friends, behavior with adults and children

4. Moving About and Manipulating Objects — walking, balance, hand skills, coordination, physical limits

5. Caring for Yourself — dressing, bathing, eating, safety awareness, handling feelings and behavior

6. Health and Physical Well-Being — illnesses, episodes, medication side effects, tiredness, hospital visits

Part 5 — After You Apply

- ☐ Keep medical and therapy care going — gaps in treatment can hurt the claim
- ☐ Tell Social Security about new diagnoses, hospital visits, or school changes
- ☐ Open every letter the day it arrives and write every deadline on a calendar
- ☐ Keep copies of everything — applications, letters, and your notes from every call

☐ Plan ahead for age 18: SSI is decided again under adult rules (see the Adult Complete Worksheet)

Please read: This worksheet is an educational tool only. It is not legal, tax, medical, or financial advice, and Southern Oak Financial & Wellness is not a law firm and does not provide legal representation. Social Security rules change — confirm current details at ssa.gov or with Social Security before you act. There is no guarantee of approval for any benefit: only the Social Security Administration decides claims. Timelines are common ranges, not promises. This worksheet is for your family's personal use only — no refunds.

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